

✦ FIELD NOTES • NO. 01

Two probes, forty-eight years, *still talking.*

Voyager 1 & 2 — the most distant human-made objects, and what they were built to carry.

Falling outward, *forever.*

No atmosphere to slow them, no destination to reach. Both coast outward at a steady clip — Voyager 1 a little faster.

~167

AU • V1 DISTANCE

~17

KM/S • CRUISE SPEED

48

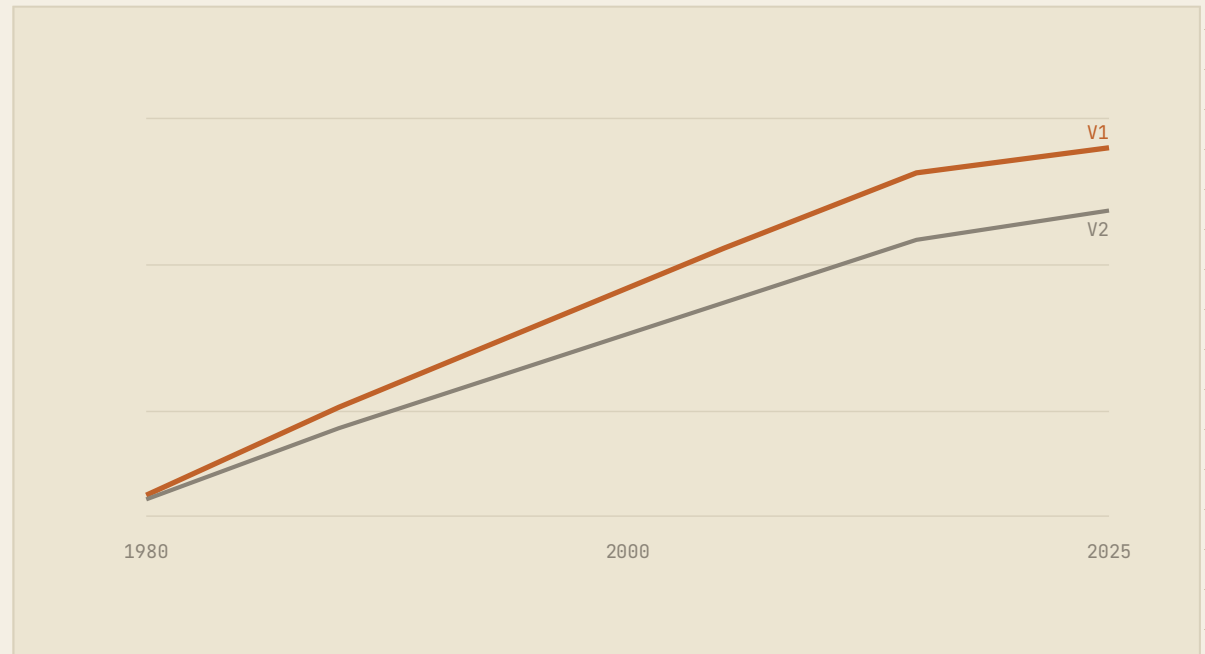
YEARS • MISSION AGE

~30%

RTG POWER LEFT

One probe, *a little faster.*

Voyager 1 took the aggressive slingshot past Saturn, bending up out of the planetary plane. Voyager 2 stayed for the full tour — and trails its twin by about 25 AU.



Each planet *flung it onward.*

- 1979 · Jupiter — active volcanoes on Io, the first seen beyond Earth.
- 1980 · Saturn — Voyager 1 dives past Titan and leaves the planetary plane.
- 1986 · Uranus — Voyager 2 alone; the only craft ever to visit.
- 1989 · Neptune — the last planet, and the end of the tour.
- 2012 / 2018 · Interstellar — both cross the heliopause, six years apart.

A gold-plated *hello*.

Bolted to each probe: a copper phonograph record plated in gold, etched with playback instructions, built to survive a billion years.

55

LANGUAGES

115

IMAGES

90

MINUTES OF MUSIC

10^9

YEAR LIFESPAN



*A present from a small, distant world — a token
of our sounds, our science, our images, our music,
our thoughts and our feelings.*

— ETCHED ABOARD, 1977